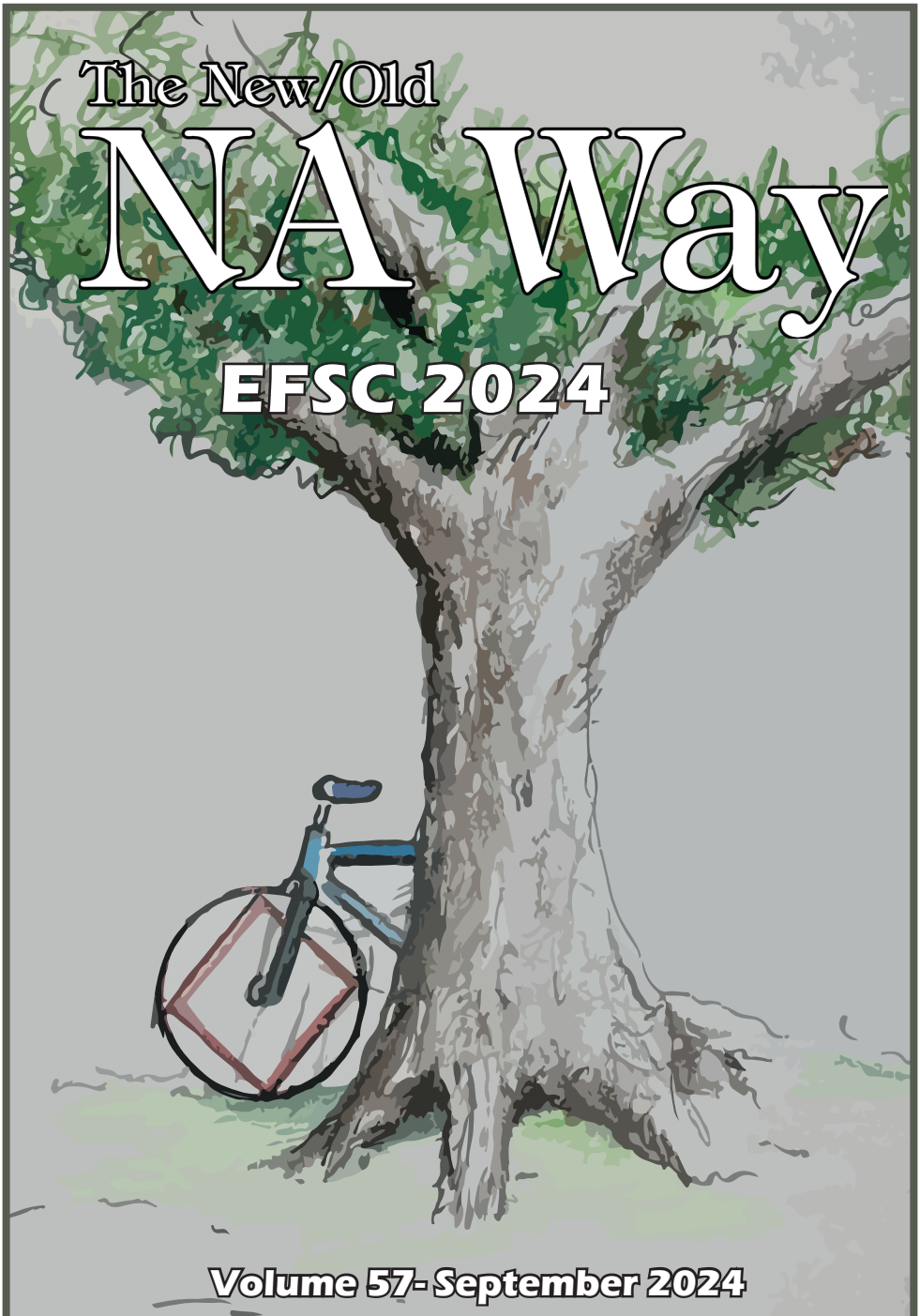
The New/Old NA Way

EFSC 2024



Volume 57- September 2024



The New/Old NA WAY Magazine
Volume 57 - September 2024
This magazine was written in open participation by
members of the Groups of The Anonymi Foundation and
members of the Groups who participate in the
Fellowship Service Conference and the
European Felloswhip Service Conference

The New/Old NA Way

Table of Contents

IP Surrender	1
Going to any lengths	4
Personal experience EFSC 2024	5
In summary, my experience of the EFSC 2024	6
Delden 2024, EFSC	7
The EFSC	7
New road	8
What does growth mean?	9
Powerlessness	9
Growth	9
The voice	10
More growth	10
Its german time	12
IP Relationships	13
“My journey to my first EFSC”	14
United we wrote	15

My Gratitude Speaks
When I Care
And When I Share
With Others
The NA Way

IP
SURRENDER - WAVING THE WHITE FLAG

The bullshit in our heads came straight from our addiction and our own will brought us to a downfall. The only surrender we knew was the surrender to our disease. To put it more simply, when we acted out on this diseased thinking, the ends were always the same: jails, institutions or death. Spiritually, physically and mentally bankrupt we hit a new low. We couldn't manage our lives on our own even though we wanted to do so very badly. This illusion needed to be shattered in order for us to get help.

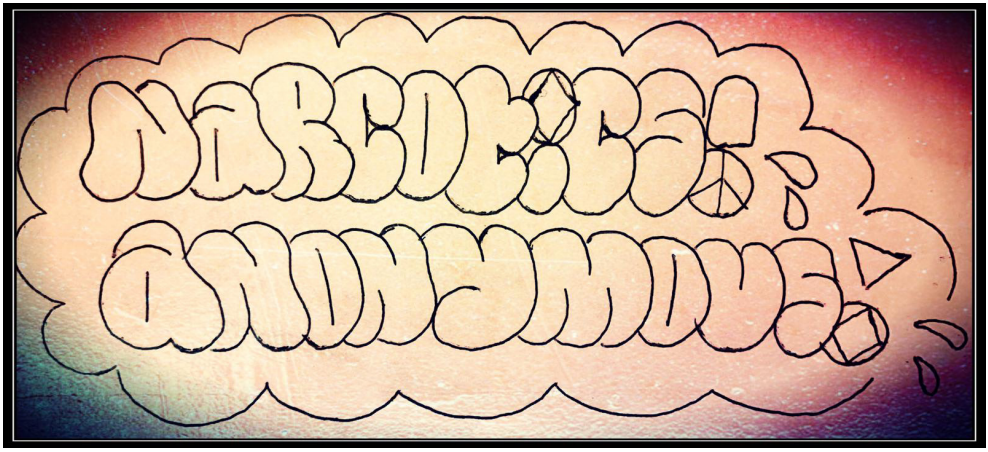
What can we do?

'The only way to win a losing battle is to surrender.'

Greybook page 153 line number 30-31

Eventually we will need to start humbly approaching our thoughts and realize we cannot believe everything our head tells us, it won't make us any wiser. When we surrender this and start letting other recovering addicts into our thoughts, the one liners "United we stand, divided we fall", and "I can't, we can" really come to life. Once we become more comfortable with other recovering addicts, we feel we are ready to look for a sponsor in whom we can put our trust to guide us through the Steps and in our recovery. In this way we surrender to the direction that will put us on the path of recovery.

For most of us getting to an N.A. meeting is our first surrender to the admission that we might have a drug problem. For others it will be the desire to stop using drugs. We are welcomed in Narcotics Anonymous, no matter who we are and what happened in our lives. Through the



state of despair we all reached, we didn't know any more than to open the door to recovery. For our closed minds and hypersensitive egos, this is a crucial moment to start accepting help. We can no longer keep our masks on and continue to run the show. We are defeated, we need help and we surrender.

On a practical level we surrender to the knowledge and wisdom from the people that went before us. We hear about the tools of recovery in meetings, and our sponsor suggests to us to practice them on a daily basis. Some essential tools are prayer, phonecalls with other recovering addicts, meetings, writing and reading. These tools will help us to keep our actions focused on recovery. We learn to surrender to a new way of life as recovering addicts.

What surrender basically means is that we do not have to fight ourselves anymore. Often we let ourselves be led by our self-obsession and let fear be our guide. This fear is present in many parts of our lives and can have us feeling fear of rejection, our personalities and fear of not doing anything right. Sometimes the fear will be so strong, panic will start to set in and we start feeling physically ill, scared there's someting wrong with our bodies. Running away and fleeing these types of feelings would be giving in to our addiction. It will keep us in a vicious cycle.

How do you surrender and let go? The things we desire are not always the things we need. Once we let go of this belief and start accepting the things we need instead of our desires, we surrender. We don't act out on fear, worry or doubt and trust that our selfwill will be taken care of and align with the will of God as we understood him.

We are addicts and it's unnatural for us to surrender, resistance however, does come natural with our disease. We fight against ourselves, our egos, fear, shame and guilt, etc. Against positive changes too. Surrender means not having to fight everything that comes our way. When a thought enters our mind or an event happens in our lives we won't fight, we can let the thought be a thought and eventually we can surrender our thoughts and be liberated from our disease.

Eventually a solution to these problems becomes evident, we can, in these moments we can call others recovering addicts, we can read our literature, start praying, meditating and put our trust in a loving God as we understood Him. Things will get better when we apply the tools and continue to do so. The results of surrendering to the principles, tools and steps of the program eventually will lead to more acceptance of ourselves, we won't be fighting ourselves anymore. Surrender is the key to acceptance and freedom.

When we start to acknowledge our disease and when we start working with what NA has to offer, we can

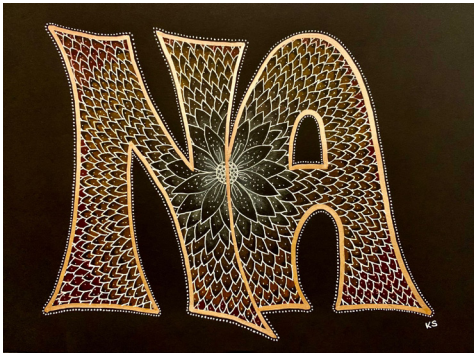
finally open up and accept help. N.A. gives us a solution to our problem. Addiction had controlled our lives and we found that we were the problem. If we are willing and apply the tools of the program, regardless how we feel or what our disease is telling us we reach a deeper level of surrender.

In order for us to grow in our recovery, some kind of spiritual awakening needs to happen in our lives. We accept the fact that we are powerless over our addiction and responsible for our recovery. This is achieved by working and living the Steps. These Steps guide us into a way of life in which we have to face ourselves and get to the roots of our disease. This is the very thing we avoided all of our lives because we couldn't handle reality. Finally, through working this program we can experience real freedom, something we desperately sought before getting to NA.

Although it might seem uncomfortable and we might not have been looking for it, we can expect to develop a relationship with a loving power greater than ourselves. Step Three tells us we can make a decision to turn our will and our lives over to the care of God as we understand him. This surrender means it's no longer up to us, the reigns are no longer in our hands.

If we trust in God and the Fellowship we will be fine. In the Fellowship we find empathy, people who know what we are going through and where we are coming from. By allowing them to join us, we feel safe and know we are not alone anymore.

As we progress in the spiritual, mental and physical recovery program of Narcotics Anonymous with our sponsor, the steps and our Home Group, we come to a better understanding of it too. This will eventually lead us to believe in a power greater than ourselves. The way we surrender our will and our lives will only deepen in meaning as we go further in our recovery. The more we grow in the program, the more we can surrender. As we follow into the footsteps of those who went before us, we can let our egos and selfwill control us less. Once we have realized that, what has worked for another, can work for us too. Our personalities will change and we will be able to live according to God's will for us.



Going to any lengths

-Alle schwierigkeiten zum trots-

That it was hard was something I noticed while I was already on my way. Sweating, sleeping in tents in small wooded areas, strong wind, eating porridge mixed with water. But organising a train ride seemed even harder I didn't even wanna bother.

My friend was having a hard time keeping the meeting running, so we had contact during a online session how we could support eachother to keep the meeting running. The way the literature wasnt free and addicts needed to save up to purchase the step guide gave me a negative gut feeling.

We (my homegroup) already established an online area and invited this friend to join us here as well to keep the meeting going. At the meeting he started sharing about how the conflict of the meeting being shut down hurt him, wich peaked my interest into the asis structure and giving out free literature. I came to the believe that the best way to learn more was to take my bike and start this journey towards the EFSC.

I figured I take my bike, riding my bike helps me to clear my mind so when i go out for a journey and it is NA related its a win win situation.

In 2024 i spent , counted up 2 months, riding my bike all across north and east Germany visiting NA



meetings and conventions. But still this time I was a bit scared to go cause it was another country and my friend couldnt makenit after all.

I took a Dutch language course before going and struggled alot with doubt, panic and paranoia on my way here. My disease wanted to keep me away. I felt grateful when I was welcomed so warm and in such surprise at how well I could communicate in all types of languages using hands feet and even some German speaking addicts here. Thank God I went to any lengths to live the NA way.

An Addict from Germany

Personal Experience EFSC 2024

On June 24, 2020 I entered a facility where I was later told by N.A. 1 month later I entered the meeting in the Netherlands at the Homegroup in Venlo. Here I kept coming back from the beginning.

Then I first got to hear about the EFSC, but did not go there then. 1 year later in 2021 I heard about the EFSC again.

Then I made the decision to go there. Full of fears I went there.

All the groups from the Netherlands came together and even people from America and Sweden were there.

My biggest fear there was to hear and speak the English language. I could not speak English, and then did everything I could to avoid everyone who spoke English.

I always found it difficult to be there at events for NA, a lot was in the english language and have always believed myself that it is not possible for me as a Dutchman to learn the language. In 2022 and 2023 I also attended EFSC, I tried to participate but that fear and the conviction that the english language is not for me still controlled me in all areas of my life.

3 months ago I made a commitment with myself to learn English.

I spend time on it every day for 113 days in a row.

Today September 13 we started the morning with group reports, it is great to hear what all the groups have been working on over the last year but also good to hear what growing paints groups are

going through in order to see how we can help each other.

Later we had a session on web reports, committees, translated projects of literature. It is great to hear that the content of the Dutch translated basic text has been approved by the groups in the Netherlands, the cover of the book will be changed a bit, when this is done we will have the books officially printed, I am looking forward to hold this book in my hands and hand it over to a newcomer, work of 10 years by addict for addict.

There are many more processes going on with literature it's great to

hear all of them and to participate in them.

Now tonight we are writing literature in groups, it is great when you look around you how the spirit do the groups works. All by addict for addict. There are great things coming up next weekend. I am looking forward to it, all the experience we gain now we can take back to the Homegroups.

In summary, my experience of the EFSC 2024.

It is great to be part of the fellowship. I overcome fears by speaking English here, not running away and participating.

N.A. has given me a desire to learn something I had completely written myself off before.

I am getting things, my mind is opened and enjoying the presence of all the addicts who are there this weekend. You feel the spirit here that cannot be described in words.

It also really gives me a deeper desire to go even more for N.A..

There are so many more opportunities to reach out and help the still suffering addict. We will continue to do this great work.

Thank you to everyone who attended this weekend.

Thank you to our predecessors in N.A.

Thank you to those who are now at N.A. and participating in fellowship.

I will continue to pray for the still suffering addict, that they may find their way to N.A.. This is what we do it for.

Thank you all!

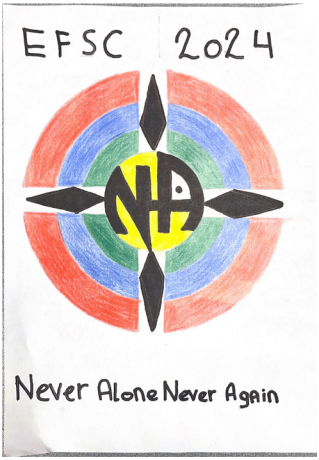
Sometimes it can seem like i'm stuck. When I don't write my inventory, it will affect my whole day. I keep promising myself to use the tools everyday. I want to recover I want to move forward, but still i sometimes choose not to write, not to pray or not to connect with fellows. How can i be growing when i keep making the same mistakes?

I also forget i'm not alone in recovery.

My sponsor told me the days I don't write keep decreasing, and the uninterrupted days i write keep increasing.

Growth is not about being perfect. It does not mean making no mistakes.

Growth is getting back on my feet



Delden 2024, EFSC

This is my second time coming to the EFSC and it feels like I'm seeing myself more clearly. My disease is becoming more apparent to me; I'm resentful, hurt and scared. Thoughts about not feeling well, not being good enough for the company I'm in.

I'm sat here with a mind that's closed, scared of connection and feeling restless.

Last year I was so nervous to come here, I was packing my stuff a month before actually leaving for the conference, that's how disease works in me, it's about wanting control. This year I've noticed such a big difference in the weeks prior to going, I felt more at peace with the fact that I'll be spending a few days with addicts, almost 3 hours away from my home. This has been given to me, no other choice than to just lean into it.

Being around recovering addicts makes me see things more clearly, their energy gives me energy too. I feel myself coming to life again, being in prayer and trying to connect to people whom I don't usually have much contact with.

Yesterday I had this awakening that I'm being dishonest in very subtle and sneaky ways. I act on personal preferences and I'm not living and practicing gratitude.

I'm uncomfortable but I feel surrendered to this experience, to being tired, being in a room full of people while wanting to run.

I'm feeling safety, warmth and love from the people around me. I'm realizing this is the best place for me to be and I must not forget I have a FEELINGS DISEASE.

I feel love when I practice gratitude and pray during uncomfortable moments, when looking out for another addict. Making myself part of the bigger picture, that is my responsibility to take, which is also the theme of this years conference; responsibility and accountability.

With the help of the fellowship all is possible.

THE EFSC

The efsc is an annual event, where we come together with all groups.

to be together, and learn from each other, as groups and as a fellowship in the whole that we can grow together.

Personal growth is also discussed here.

A lot happens in the days before the EFSC, tensions of being with a large group of people... will I be accepted? certain people don't like me! There are already excuses for not going. that is where the disease wants me.

By calling my sponsor, and then collecting the bags in the car, and after an hour's drive. then I arrived at the EFSC with the people where half a word is usually enough for me. it feels familiar again, giving everyone a hug and welcoming new people,

and we are HOME again!!

The insecurities are still present, but here I am safe, safe to learn to deal with discomfort. these 50+ people have all gone through this. the shame can come down the walls. It feels like a 4 day meeting. where you actually don't want to go home on Sunday...

If you read that, give yourself a chance to be there. you are

New Road

I am just beginning to take steps on a new road. The old road has appeared to me as: **NOT WORKING**. Since December 2023, I walked in at "the Ismes Huis," downtown in Den Bosch, but my addiction was always ahead of me. That meant that I showed my face at NA meetings for a short period, taking place for periods of not coming. But something inside tells me that there is something in or at the NA meeting that resonates with a deep inner hunger and need. NA meeting is a warm bath with shoes that breaks right through my concrete shield built up in year on year, throughout my life. Probably began at a very young age. Now I write this: I dropped myself at my first EFSC. I'm shaking as hell! Just for 2 days clean. I am shiffering throughout the day. Nothing to control. Nothing to consume but good food and good coffee. I am thankfull I am here with a lot of good people. But it also scares me. Do they like me? Am I allright? Am I enough? My hunger for something to take back the curtain over my mind is huge. This is my part for now. Thanx!



What does growth mean?

I'm often blind to see whether or not I'm growing. I'm blinded by self-pity or discontent of where I'm at in life. Addiction takes away our skill to be unprejudiced about ourself and I find myself in places I didn't intent to be. It's not that I wake up and decide: "You know what? Today I'm going to watch porn, call in sick and isolate." But then I do and I'm faced with how strong addiction is. I can feel alone when I'm like that and in my head I feel like I'm doomed to be like this forever. But in recovery I'm realizing that it's not about finding out why things go bad, but rather finding out how to do things right. When I feel the urge to watch porn, I don't have to do it. That's a choice.

Although I can at times feel alone, today I know I'm never alone, until I choose to be alone. But reaching out I receive a glimpse of God, clear voyance and break the chain of the disease. We're being restored to sanity day by day. And that is growth.

Growth is realizing I need to grow, but also that with NA WE can grow!

Powerlessness?

At first we have no clear clue what powerlessness is, other than an ugly word, which associates with negativity.

We are powerless over physical and emotional pain. Such as frustration, irritation, disappointment, all expectations.

In many times we deny the truth, our own truth!

Before we got introduces with the ideas of NA we were unable to feel what we felt. Now we need to learn how to identify and deal with everything which we cannot control. We learn to deal with the reality, to deal with life in all its aspects.

The first thing we have to do is to put our ego's aside, to accept the fact that we are powerless in many ways.

When you do not humble yourself, the disease will do it for you.

To be able to grow we need stability in our lives.

NA provides us with an environment of support and recognition to do this, free from judgement.

In NA we find the stability to learn to be ourselves. Regardless the people, places, things, at any given time.

Growth

For me, growth means that my journey through life changes in a positive way.

When I first came to NA, I didn't have a purpose or meaning in my life. As I stayed clean longer, my perspective changed. The way I thought about NA also changed, which gave me a different way of handling life.

Although my feelings can go from high to low, I discovered that growth comes with pain, and pain comes

with growth.

This journey and my life have been chaotic so far, but I have learned so much from other NA members and my sponsor.

I am blessed to experience growth despite all the struggles and pain that come with it.

Sometimes I forget how wonderful my life is today. I am very blessed with my family and friends. They even say that they see me growing in every possible way. However, for my growth to continue, I have to take responsibility both in and outside of NA. The best thing about it is that I can make mistakes; it's okay to have periods where I don't feel happy or motivated. That's not a problem as long as I keep going to meetings, do my writing, make phone calls, pray, and meditate. It's okay not to be okay.

Right now, at this moment, I feel like I have no motivation to write every day or take responsibility, but in the end, I know I have to do what is good for me.

I have my own NA group and my sponsor to help me get back on track and grow in my life, and that is how we all grow together.

The voice

In my head there is a voice that likes telling lies, a voice that wants to tell me that I can't write. I am not good enough. To see people being good at stuff makes me feel like I don't know where I belong in the fellowship because I am not good at what they are doing. But not me. But here we go and choose to start writing and we see where it goes. And go against the voice in my head.

Och And remind myself why iam here. Iam here because i'm an addict and my problem is addiction .But obviously i can write. Because you're reading this And being grateful that I can choose action and surrender. In my head a want think bit is not good enough. But what is good enough? Something made by my ego and my head. I have a long way to go to stop the voice in my head or at least learn not to listen to it /handle it but I know as long as I keep coming back being clean even on hard days it will all be good. And I hope this can inspire someone to write and go against the voice.

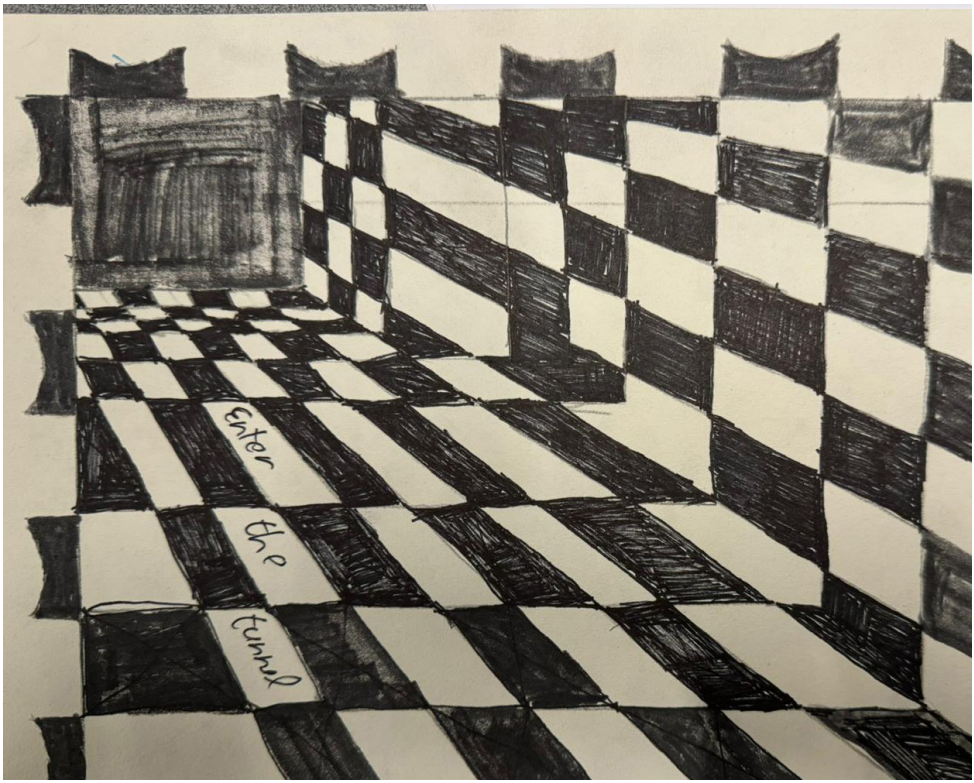
Love from Sweden

More Growth

When the word "growth" is being said my first reaction is – is there any? If so, I'm having trouble to see it, which doesn't need to be something bad knowing from experience there's always room to improve. Being in NA and working a daily program we know from experience lacking our daily program will prevent us from growing. Even worse, it will strip from our growth and start the process of going back into old behaviors and eventually bring us down to our knees.

Whenever I feel gratitude for someone else's growth, I know I'm growing. I need to work very closely with my sponsor. I surrender to this new way of life and I will see moments of growth. Where there is effort I put into my recovery, growth will come sooner than it has. It always has. The more we put in, the more we get back from it. When we work these steps, God will present to us growth, but for that, we need to be good servants and surrender to the new way of life. We learn to adapt through our program. Growth takes time and a lot of effort, just like saving up for something big. The people around me always remind me of how a different person I have become. I don't need to ask for it. One of the best growths I have experienced so far is that I will be honest today, and don't have to be someone else to be liked or accepted.

An Anonymous addict from Hengelo.



Its german time

The vision was a german translated third edition basic text. The result was a german translated third edition basic text. It took a year but really it was 56 days of everyday commitment to get it done getting together with fellow addicts and working on this using online translating tools and prayer.

This was one of the first big service for NA projects I personally committed myself to and it was a ride to me. I wouldn't have thought this would help me in the many ways it did help me. Learning more about myself, my disease, working together and eventually the commitment even prepared me for the job I was about to get.

The idea started cause addicts from the german Fellowship got together at the EFSC 2023 and started handing out 5th edition basic



texts with inserted original 4th and 9th traditions for free! We figured this was a great gesture but the book wasn't working out because it wasn't our own translation.

So this idea kind of lingered and I kept thinking 'lets get it started I should get it started why am I not getting this started??!!!!' I did not ask for help. I did not share with other recovering addicts doing service and I was not truly committing myself to this. It was revealed to me once it was StepRetreat time and I realised all that was left to do was do it.

Stop fighting. Write the book together. And then give it to the Fellowship. The letting go of that felt unexpectedly painful. The book became my baby and I was quite unwilling to let go of that. However I think God helped me be relieved of this through prayer and stepwork I got to see how my need to control how other people see me interfered with this being a spiritual process. I wanted it to be me getting the credits! Now realising all credits to God, NA and the Fellowship.

Now the book is handed over. We are getting started on the next phase, its now up for review and input and we're working on organising a translation day to read it together and inserting the input into it. It'll be a Fellowship approved german basic text ready to be used at german NA meetings that are yet to be set up using the A.S.I.S for NA. May God guide us in this process.

IP Relationships

Most of our relationships were heavily influenced by our addiction.

At the end of our using the only relationship we had that really mattered was with our drugs. We where stuck in a destructive way of life that isolated us from others and society as a whole. This painful isolation made us desperate and led us to the Fellowship of Narcotics Anonymous.

In the Fellowship of NA we found people like ourselves. We could relate when we heard them share their feelings and thoughts during the meetings. Most of us felt isolated from other people and uncomfortable in our own skin, even before we started using drugs.

By coming to meetings we put ourselves in a position where we have a chance to share our time, thoughts and feelings with other recovering addicts. By doing this we give up our isolation. This is the start of getting back into the realm of connecting to other people and building relationships. Something most of us had to relearn or learn for the first time.

A romantic relationship is appealing to us, because it quickly gives us a good feeling. But this pamflet is not about starting a romantic relationship. In our experience we first have to learn what love means, because this feeling is unknown to us. Love and lust can be a very powerful drug. But how can we be capable of being

in a romantic relationship when we don't know ourselves and what we have to offer to another person.

The commitment of a relationship is often difficult for us. A friendly relationship scares us because we do not know how to stay committed to someone or something. We wanted others to be committed to us, but be free of commitment ourselves.

Even our relationship with the world was distorted. We could blame everyone and everything.

We need to rebuild how we stand in the world and how we relate to our surroundings and other people. We were unable to feel connected emotionally. Based on past experiences we often kept people at a save distance, because we expected them to hurt or leave us. We did not like the feelings that came up when people got closer to us, no matter what kind of relationship it was.

We where used to using people to give us whatever we thought we needed. Our relationships where often conditional. We did not know how to love or how to be loved. We felt welcomed in NA, but did not know what that feeling was. With the help of a sponsor we started to look at our patterns. We looked daily at how we related to the world and other people, and started to see how we used them to get what we thought we needed. We where dependent on them, and started to learn that we had to become responsible for ourselves and our lives. By working the program and following suggestions we learn to built a relationship with our sponsor. In the beginning this is the most important relationship we can work on. Because our sponsor will guide us through the Steps, and the Steps will guide us towards a relationship with God, ourselves and the world around us. The Fellowships of NA is a great place to pratice building relationships.

By working the Steps, we let other people get to know us. And that way we find out who we really are, and how we should and want to relate to others. This way we are able to become part of humanity, and have relationships of real values.

By Anonymous addicts at the EFSC

"My journey to my first EFSC."

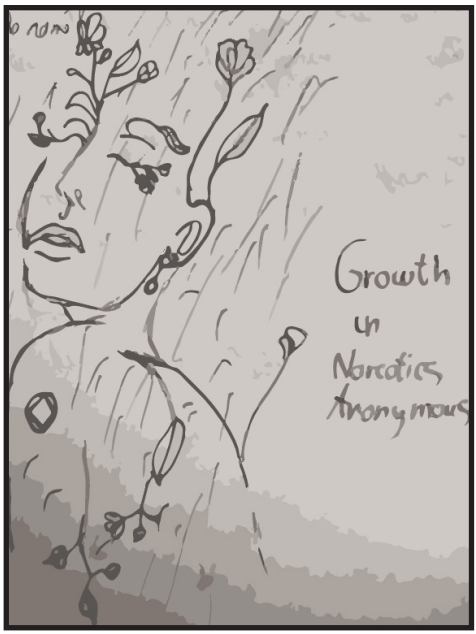
At this EFSC we had a literature workshop and a few members enquired a member who was here for the first time and we wanted to know how she was informed about the EFSC.

It all started in 2020 when online meetings were very trendy. She attended online GreyBook meetings in England & America while living in Ireland and got acquainted with the GreyBook. In the same time she also got introduced to the podcast 'Anonymous Unity' on Spotify where

she heard about www.nahelp.org, Groups.io aka RFNA, and the EFSC were mentioned and she was curious about that. She went on RFNA, got some information about the EFSC and signed up.

One of the suggestions of her sponsor was to get out of her comfortzone and learn to do things by herself, so this was a great opportunity and at the same time a great challenge. She didn't know what to expect and decided to not have any expectations and go through all feelings that would come to pass.

Because she listened to the podcast daily, she realized she wasn't going to a convention, with fundraising, merchandise and what not...., she was going to a conference with an undiluted message.



Never doubted to cancel, went through fear and other uncomfortable feelings and emotions and arrived at the EFSC in Delden. It was very special to hear her story and how she got introduced to the original message of NA and the EFSC.

United we wrote

Article one: Unity at the EFSC

Together with another addict, we began writing this article, focused on unity at the EFSC. Here at the EFSC, we find ourselves in a place where many of our fears come to the surface. We are exposed to a group of people who have a lot of connection with each other, which can make us feel uncomfortable, scared, and uncertain. Yet, we see something in these people. They are cheerful, connected with each other, represent their Homegroup, do great work together, and support each other.

It's strange; person to person, we are very different from each other. We haven't experienced exactly the same things in the past. One was a quiet user, while another was deeply involved in crime. Still, we seem to have a lot in common. We all have the disease of addiction; we couldn't live with or without drugs. We didn't know how to live in the world we were in. We all reached a certain point of despair. This despair brings us to NA, which is the point where we can talk to each other and help each other in this new way of life.

As scared as we are at the beginning, the more trust we later gain in the Fellowship. People do not reject us. They are loving and caring and include us. You see people who were naturally fearful loners blooming in the Fellowship during the EFSC. They have fun, feel connected, participate in workshops, and are part of the unity in the Fellowship.

It is a process; for years we have shut ourselves off from the outside world. Now the doors are opening to a new way of living, where fears diminish and may even disappear to a certain extent. We need to live and work together as a group to ensure that, during a storm, our ship does not sink and our members do not perish. With trust in a Power Greater than ourselves, hard work, and unity, we will continue to endure and carry the message to the addict who still suffers.

We are working together on a greater whole; that is to reach and help the still-suffering addict. That is the unity that connects us in NA.

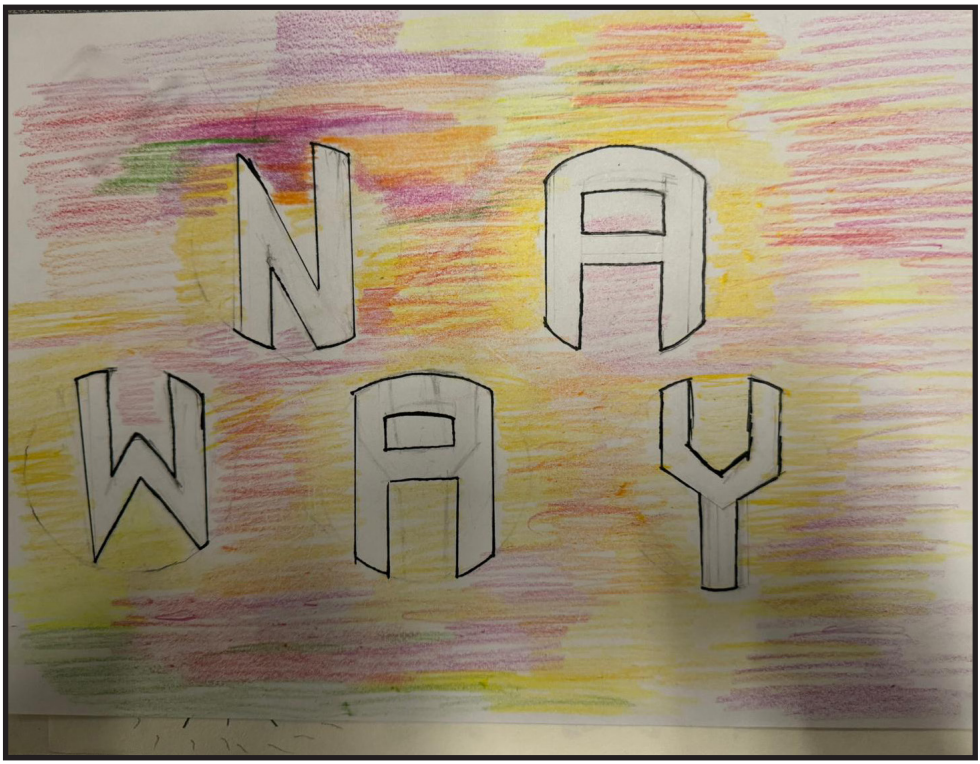
Never Alone, Never Again!

Article two:

In the past few days at the EFSC, we were with 50 addicts seeking recovery and wanting to live clean. It is a miracle to see that when we addicts work on our recovery and come together in the NA Fellowship, something happens that cannot be explained. We, who always thought we had to do it alone, have found people like ourselves. When we come together, something beautiful happens. Everything we do during these days is primarily to carry our message of recovery to the newcomer. Each year, there are people attending the EFSC for the first time. I still remember how it was for me the first time. I felt overwhelmed and at the same time welcomed and very emotional. It feels strange to say, but it felt like coming home. So many people I had never met before; it was frightening but also exciting. I was restless and could barely sit still for half an hour. I was afraid of silences, so I talked non-stop. But there was also a fear of not being good enough. It was so impressive to see how people invested time and energy in organizing all of this. People from all over the world were there. It touches my soul that these people dedicate themselves selflessly to a greater purpose. I didn't understand it all yet, but something made me want to experience everything. It felt like a warm bath, something I had missed my entire life. I was a newcomer that year, and I was taken care of. I was mainly focused on myself—how I came across to others, whether people liked me, whether they found me too restless and too much. It was that familiar egocentric attitude of mine that always led to discord. From that fear of not being good enough, I was always insecure. That insecurity drove me to seek validation in various ways. For a large part of my life, I was

searching for money, power, and sex. That had become my way of living. Outshouting myself, giving away my body, and associating with people who were supposedly cool were ways I tried to control my insecurity and to get money and drugs. I was always the one causing disunity, always part of the problem. And I made problems out of everything in my own head. In my eyes, the whole world was against me, and I was against the whole world. I thought I could do it alone. The first EFSC was like that, but no one rejected me. There was always a seat for me, at every event, at every meeting, wherever it was.

My Fourth EFSC I have a Home Group to which I have been committed for several years and have gone through many growing pains with other members. Together with my sponsor, who helps me with the Steps, I have learned to face myself. To examine how my personality affects others and how my personality reacts to life. By actively participating in NA and working on the Steps, I have learned that it is not about me. At events like these, I am just a small part of the whole and have the privilege of serving NA with all humility. The entire process of a daily Program and self-examination has allowed me to be part of the



solution. And to learn to be a positive, unifying factor in the Fellowship and beyond. By living according to the principles of NA, my perspective on reality has changed, and I truly feel connected to the Fellowship. It is no longer about me. Unity allows me to carry the message of recovery to the newcomer together with others in NA. With God, as I understand Him, I find the strength and courage I need to do good in every area of my life and can also witness the miracles happening in others in NA who, like me, have found a new way of living. Life has become an adventure. I don't know what will happen tomorrow, but only for today, I learn to deal with life as it comes and accept that I don't determine this.

By 2 anonymous addicts from The Netherlands




EFSC
SAVE THE DATE
2025
11 - 14 SEPTEMBER
AMBT DELDEN - KROEZE DANNE
NAHELP.NL

20th Annual Fellowship Service

Conference for N.A.

When: June 27th thru June 29th, 2025

Where: Hamburg, PA

Place. Olivet Mountain Camp 1540 Mountain Ave.

Hamburg, PA 19526

Cost: $135.00 per person

Price includes all meals {and lodging if needed}

There is no registration fee all money goes directly to pay for the facility and food

Write checks payable to Historical Perspective Group

For More Information: Contact Historical Perspective Group

(610) 428-9923 Ask for Ray: or e-mail **— matrixmatclub@yahoo.com**

Check Out Our Web www.nahelp.org/ **Send check to: A.S.I.S. For NA**

P.O. Box 4404 Allentown, Pa 18105 Write checks payable to

Historical Perspective Group of NA (Bring sheets, pillows, Towels, and soap everything else provided)

Name: _____ E - Mail: _____

Address: _____City _____State:

_____ Zip: _____ Phone Number (____) _____-

_____

Group Name_____ **Register by June 10, 2025**



Amount $135.00 Check NO _____



(Adversity does not build character, it Reveals it.)
More Will Be Revealed

The Groups of Northern Columbiana County Area of Narcotics Anonymous presents

Annual 12 Step Retreat

February, 21,22&23, 2025

Das Dutch Village Inn

150 East State Route 14

Columbiana, Ohio 44408

What to expect: Speakers, Discussion, Coffee,

Real NA Old School Recovery!

Only $5.00 for the weekend if you pre-register - $10.00 at the door

NO addict EVER turned away!

Pre-register by e-mailing stepretreat@yahoo.com

Rooms call for Price per night for 2 adults ($10.00 additional for each adult)

Reserve your room by January 1, 2025, and mention you are with the NA Retreat to get the discounted price - Call 330-482-5050

.

Reserve your room by January 1, 2025, and mention you are with the NA Retreat to get the discounted price - Call 330-482-5050

Upcoming Events

20th Annual Fellowship Service Conference for N.A.
Date: June 27th thru June 29th, 2025
Hamburg, PA

Annual 12 Step Retreat
Date: February 21 thru 23, 2025
Colombiana Ohio

EFSC NETHERLANDS
Date: September 11th thru 14th , 2025
Ambt Delden, The Netherlands

Your event here? Send information to info@nahelp.org

Weblinks

www.nahelp.org
Contact: info@nahelp.org
World
www.nahelp.nl
Contact: nahelp.nl@gmail.com
The Netherlands
www.freerecovery.org.uk
United Kingdom

www.nahelp.se
Sweden
Contact: AntligenFriaNA@gmail.com
www.nahelp.ru
Russia

GET INVOLVED!

WE NEED YOUR INPUT!

Please send your articles, event information, comics or other input to:

info@nahelp.org

Your Fellowship Magazine
Share... and be shared with..

Like it was when NA was new and young and life or death intense:
Youmattertoussowewilltellyouthetruthasweknow it with nothing held back.

THE
NEW/OLD
NA
WAY

"... so that no addict seeking recovery need ever die..."
We publish your input -- the opinions presented are not necessarily those of the New/Old NA Way or Anonymi Foundation